we found out, if you're an international sportsman. There's none of this, 'Am I reading the signals correctly here?' crap. Nope, the message is hand-delivered to you in capital letters. Most of the time we didn't have to go and look for girls either. They came hunting, often in packs, and if they liked what they saw, you were in for the ride of your life. Fascinating social behaviour. They should study it … make a documentary on the Discovery channel. I'd watch it.

It started with the Perth Stripper, as she fondly became known. During one of the tour's warm-up games, a couple of the guys and I weren't playing and, as a result, we were sharing the twelfth-man drinks duties. We saw this pretty girl sitting right in front of the players' viewing area and, as we'd find out a little later, she happened to be a stripper. But, more than that, she was a stripper who enjoyed cricket. And there can't be too many of them around. No doubt she would've appreciated Gary Kirsten's great knock that day – he got around 200, if I remember correctly. An unbelievable knock, actually.

As any youngster in a team will tell you, being on twelfth-man duties can be a bit of a schlep. All you want to do is be on the pitch, playing; sitting on the sidelines gets really frustrating. One tends to turn one's attention to attractions in the stadium rather than the sparkling cricket being played out in the middle. And that's how our attention happened to fall upon this fine young Australian lass. The three of us started chatting to her, and eventually we invited her to join us for a drink at our hotel at 8 p.m. that evening. She was very punctual.

We all got together in one of the okes' rooms and we had a bottle of wine. More drinks followed, and things started to loosen up a little … And then the girl happened to mention that she was a stripper and that, if we wanted, she would strip for us.

Things loosened up a lot more after that. Various items of clothing were removed in an eyebrow-raising kind of way, and one thing invariably led to another. I led the warm-up session, but then left after about 40 minutes. The rest of them stayed behind.

And basically the tour just kicked on from there. It got the ball rolling in a big way. A few nights later, there was a matric dance at the hotel – huge party, girls galore. I spotted one particularly gorgeous girl, obviously dressed to the nines, walking around the hotel lobby. I thought, 'Well, hell,